

No one has

technology

like Sprint



COVER STORY

Y SPIRIT PEOPLE TECHNOLOGY CUSTOMERS BENEFITS FINANCIAL MODEL COMMUNITY SPIRIT PEOPLE TECHN

In mid-December, Yat-Sang Hung began wearing a wristwatch phone at home, at work and everywhere in-between. He wasn't playing Dick Tracy. He was learning the ins and outs of a new technology left behind by a dozen Samsung business partners, who had just returned to their native Korea after spending a month in Kansas City.

It didn't take Hung a day to come to a conclusion about the wristwatch phone. "It's not user friendly," he says. "You have to keep holding it up to your head to conduct a decent conversation."

Hung is the chief scientist for Sprint PCS. He's paid to research, understand and link the latest technological developments with viable commercial products. His group already has an enviable record. *Business Week*, the nation's largest business magazine, gave the Sprint PCS Samsung Touchpoint Phone its Best Product Award for 1999. "It's been out two-and-one-half years," Hung says. "It's nice when someone says the phone you designed beats everyone else in the industry."

The honor is as much a testament to the Sprint brand as anything else. "We cater to the user," Hung says. "We do a lot of research, so we understand the lifestyles of the people who buy phones from us. Sprint PCS is a great company to work for. We have a true entrepreneurial spirit."

When Hung finished his first degree at the University of Hong Kong, he majored in cognitive psychology and then computer science at State University of New York in Buffalo. "I've always been interested in interdisciplinary research and the cross between psychology and computers," Hung relates. "My specialty is human/computer interaction or MMI (Man-Machine Interface)."

Although he enjoyed a three-year stint at US West Technologies in Denver and two years with a software development company in Houston, Sprint PCS was the perfect match for Hung five years ago. "Sprint PCS supports artificial intelligence," he says. "We study the human mind and use

computers to model how people see and hear. We work together in teams and spend a lot of time with original equipment manufacturers — both here and abroad. We're known for our creativity and innovation. We believe in all the details of development, but we never lose sight of speed to market."

Ergonomics and integration are key words in Hung's vocabulary. He worked with Samsung on a new MP3 portable handset launched in November.

"It's capable of recording CD-quality MP3 music downloaded from the Internet," he says. "It's a dual-band phone with voice-activated dialing and a browser for the Sprint PCS Wireless Web."

No one knows what's next. "All I know is Sprint PCS will keep pushing as hard as we can to succeed in the marketplace," Hung promises. "We will never be satisfied. We will push ourselves and go way beyond where we've been. And we will do it for one reason ... our customers."

by Randy York
randy.york@mail.sprint.com

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For more information on Sprint PCS products visit
www.sprintpcs.com.

Sprint PCS Chief Scientist Yat-Sang Hung prefers the handset he designed over the wristwatch phone (pictured here) he tested in December.

